

Assignment #5: Recommendation Report

Total Points: 350

Purpose

For our final project, your group will write an 6-10-page recommendation report on an issue associated with your intended major. You'll identify a specific audience, but you can count on writing to a group of people who are interested in your topic but doesn't know much about it. You'll supplement the report with an 8-10-minute presentation, using PowerPoint, Keynote, Prezi, Google Slides, or your preferred presentation platform in front of our class.

Report Types and Topics

As our text points out, reports come in many varieties. For our project, we'll use the book's "middle-ground" definition: "A business report is an orderly and objective communication of factual information that serves a business purpose" (200). The business purpose of your report is to recommend a change.

Your group has tremendous flexibility regarding topics. First, you should write about something your group is interested in. If possible, you should be passionate about the topic, and each member must buy into the topic. Perhaps more importantly, you need to choose a topic that will yield enough content for a strong, well-developed document.

The report's primary goal is to recommend a change, but you will also offer analysis and present conclusions drawn from research you conduct. You may, for example, write a report that:

- compares marketing strategies of various companies and propose an alternative for a business or type of businesses;
- presents different models of human resource management, then recommend one that your group believes works best for a certain business sector;
- recommends an investment strategy for a specific consumer group, like students.

I'll be working closely with your group to define a topic and choose a type. We'll also rely heavily on chapters 12 and 13 in our book, especially when we define problem and purpose statements and determine the factors you need to investigate.

Importance of Research

Your report must rely on research to inform and persuade your reader. She is expecting you to provide a range of in-depth, high-quality facts and/or observations. Remember, your reader will be making a decision based on the information you provide. You'll begin by conducting some general research about the topic, issue or trend using Google or another search engine. Then you will find more targeted research using the databases accessed through our RWS 290 Course Guide via SDSU's library. Again, this is a professional document; your report must rely on at the very least five sources.

Visuals/Executive Summary/Cover Letter/Tone

Your report must also include graphic elements (visuals); we will discuss citation format, integrating figures, tables, charts and graphs into the report in class. You will also submit a cover letter. The report must be written in a professional tone/style defined by our text.

Supplemental Assignments

Your group will complete these supplemental assignments for the Report Project

- A **Team Charter** that establishes group expectations and protocol.
- A **Gantt chart**, which is a great tool for focusing on the most critical tasks required to complete a project.
- A brief **Kickoff Memo** presenting the report's problem and purpose statements describing the background of the report's topic, and listing the "factors" the report will investigate.
- A Report **Progress Report Memo** that reports on your work to date.
- An 8-10-minute presentation on the report, during (which each member must speak.)
- A confidential Collaboration Report quiz, where you evaluate each member of your group. (You'll find descriptions for each of these supplemental assignments in our module.)

Coursework, Point Totals and Due Dates

Team Charter	10	11/8	11:59 pm
Kickoff Memo	10	11/13	11:59 pm
Gantt Chart	10	11/13	11:59 pm
Report Progress Memo	10	11/25	11:59 pm
Report First Draft	10	12/3	11:59 pm
Report Presentation	50	12/8	In Class
Report Final Draft:	200	12/13	11:59 pm
Collaboration Assessment	50	12/13	11:59 pm
Total Points		350	

Report Page Specifications

Length: At least 4 pages of body text
Length: No more than ten pages
Margins: 1 inch all around
Line Space: Single
Justification: Ragged right
Paragraph Length: "Chunked," varied
Paragraph Breaks: Line space; no indent
Font Size: 11pt for serif, 12 for sans serif
Headings: No more than 3pts larger than text type size
Heading Line space: One line space above, one below
Bulleted/Numbered Lists: Yes, for appropriate content

Page Numbers: Bottom, flush right margin, text size
Hyperlinks: Not active
Text Citations: Footnote format; font size 9pt
Visuals: Yes, framed with adequate white space
Visual Captions: Placed per convention in 9pt font size
Visuals Citations: Yes, for all non-original visuals
Executive Summary: Yes, not counted in page count
Title Page: Yes, with course name, instructor name, report title, group name, individual names
Cover Letter: Yes; standard transmittal letter format

Evaluation

To evaluate your group's report, I'll use the Recommendation Report Rubric posted on our Canvas module.